

GREY BANNER ALERT



Serious Incident – Final Notice

CRITICAL RISK: Electric Shock and Arc Flash

Date of Incident	16 March 2026	Time of Incident	14:30
Directorate / Region	OMTID	Main Roads or Contractor	Contractor
isafe Event Type	Near Miss	isafe Incident Number	INC- 0000094
Actual Consequence	Moderate	Potential Consequence	Major
Reportable to WorkSafe	No	Type of Notifiable Incident	N/A

Incident Short Description	Electrical Arc During Asset Removal
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Executive Summary

During the removal of a redundant Western Power asset that had previously been disconnected, a worker commenced cutting an orange conduit protecting a low-voltage electrical cable in preparation for the installation of a new service. While using a reciprocating saw, contact was made with multiple conductors, resulting in an electrical arc flash.

The arc flash was caused by a short-circuit between conductors via the saw blade and ceased when the circuit was interrupted. No electric shock was sustained; however, under different circumstances the event had the potential to result in serious burn injuries.

No injuries were reported. As a precautionary measure, the involved worker underwent an ECG assessment.



Area Overview



Vaporisation of the saw blade

Contributing Factors

- Asset status was not verified through testing before work commenced.
- External works were incomplete, leaving the cable connected to the live network.
- Asset status was assumed based on previous communications rather than confirmed on site.
- Communication created uncertainty regarding the asset's condition.

- The work crew relied on verbal advice and management understanding rather than independent verification.
- Work was not deferred until the asset status could be conclusively confirmed.

Corrective Actions

- Clearly define who is authorised to confirm the status of electrical network assets and communicate this to all workers.
- Complete a risk assessment before disturbing any abandoned or decommissioned electrical assets, including verifying whether they are energised where practicable.
- Review and update the SWMS and project risk assessment with input from workers and subject matter experts.
- Ensure suitably qualified and authorised personnel, equipment and processes are available to verify asset status before work begins.
- Review and improve the permit-to-work process to better identify and communicate the status of decommissioned assets.

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations